



City Council August 1, 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KUOsJteugGI
Publication Date	2022-11-07T19:31:37Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Common Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: August 1, 2022

Body: Common Council of the City of Muncie, Indiana

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Note: The transcript does not contain a formal statutory public hearing held immediately prior to the call to order. However, committee reports and presentations occurred during the main agenda.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Robbins called the August 1, 2022 meeting of the Common Council to order at [00:00:13](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Ingram, Mr. Garrett, Mr. Overby, Mr. Dishman, Mr. Green, Mr. Polk, Mr. Clark, Ms. Selby (Selvey), and President Robbins.
 - **Absent:** None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The Pledge of Allegiance was led by Mr. Rick Yentzer [00:00:16](#).
 - A moment of silence was held to remember victims of recent community crimes [00:00:37](#).
 - Citizen recognition was noted for the following month (Councilwoman Selvey) [00:01:21](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - The minutes from the July 11th meeting were approved by roll call vote (Moved by Councilman Green, seconded by Councilman Ingram) [00:01:52](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:07:04](#) **Ordinance 23-22:** An ordinance for additional appropriations <U+2013> Muncie Fire Department EMS.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by the Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion confirmed that EMS funds are being used to purchase police vehicles, fire department vehicles, and radios.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Audi Barber ([00:07:30](#)) spoke on the record confirming that EMS funds are being utilized for these vehicle and equipment purchases.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (9-Yes roll call vote) [00:08:11](#).
- [00:08:34](#) **Ordinance 24-22:** An ordinance for additional appropriations <U+2013> Muncie Police Department.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by the Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed extensively in the prior month regarding police department funding. Council members and Deputy Chief Deegan commended the department's exhaustive work on a recent triple homicide.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Audi Barber ([00:08:56](#)) thanked the Muncie Police Department for their tireless work amid rising crime. Deputy Chief Deegan ([00:10:17](#)) thanked the public and council for their support and reiterated the department's commitment to community safety.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (9-Yes roll call vote) [00:11:11](#).
- [00:07:04](#) **Ordinance 25-22:** Designation of economic development target area <U+2013> White River Plaza area.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by the Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Councilman Green requested that financial quotes and numbers regarding roof and parking lot repairs be presented prior to upcoming subcommittee meetings.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (9-Yes roll call vote) [00:12:41](#).
 - **00:13:03 Ordinance 26-22:** (Beach Grove Cemetery internal rules/regulations ordinance).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by the Council / Beach Grove representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Withdrawn at the request of Beach Grove officials as they revise their internal rules and intend to bring an updated version back to the council next month [00:13:10](#). Council members also praised new Beach Grove Superintendent Troy Waters for rapid improvements to the historic cemetery and announced a community open house for the chapel on September 10th [00:14:04](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Withdrawn [00:16:44](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:17:13 Eldon Solomon (CEO and Director, The Journey Home):**
Spoke regarding outreach services for at-risk and homeless veterans. Highlighted that the organization has assisted 61 veterans in the Muncie area and noted national statistics regarding veteran housing insecurity. Requested community awareness, local partnerships, and financial support from the city/council.
- **00:25:18 Janetta Presley:**
Announced the opening of the Robert Hunt Warming and Cooling Center at the Garden of Gethsemane church (open Monday, Wednesday, Friday from 1:00 PM to 5:00 PM, serving meals). Shared goals to eventually expand operating hours overnight to assist unhoused residents.
- **00:27:55 Rick Yentzer:**
Expressed concern over American Rescue Plan funds and Board of Works allocations to the Sanitary District. Questioned city budget shortfalls, borrowing practices, and the allocation of funds relative to local substance abuse and homelessness needs.
- **00:30:34 Mary Stilts:**
Expressed strong support for The Journey Home and proposed a community fundraiser for veterans. Raised concerns about the visibility of local government meetings on Comcast Channel 60 and requested a Comcast representative to address missing local broadcast feeds. (Mark Slusher responded regarding technical uploads to Comcast [00:34:10](#)).
- **00:38:20 Sheila Albertson:**
Addressed neighborhood issues near East Memorial Drive and Elm Street, including a lack of bike lanes, dangerous speeding, poor sidewalk accessibility for disabled residents/wheelchairs, and severe stormwater drainage problems. Also mentioned reporting a suspicious individual matching a public composite sketch to police.
- **00:46:56 Audi Barber:**
Praised sidewalk cleanup efforts on West Memorial Drive. Proposed a new ordinance

requiring city council approval for renaming public city parks, ball diamonds, or landmarks (referencing recent changes at McCullough Park). Expressed concern over the future of the historic BK Rootbeer stand.

- **00:50:32 Seth Rawlings:**

Spoke on his 21st birthday regarding tenant complaints concerning off-campus student housing providers and property groups in Muncie. Noted city resources available via the building commissioner's office for housing code enforcement. Also highlighted the rollout of the 988 suicide prevention hotline and encouraged exploring mobile crisis response models integrating mental health professionals.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Mention of the upcoming Beach Grove Cemetery Chapel Open House scheduled for September 10th **00:16:01**.

- **Adjournment:**

- The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Councilman Polk, seconded by Councilman Ingram, and approved by voice vote **00:16:07**.

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